

Christ Sinlessness

doc-christ-sinlessness

Christology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Jesus Christ was without sin in His thoughts, words, and deeds throughout His earthly life.

In plain language

Five New Testament voices, working independently, deny sin of Jesus using the same core word for sin and different ways of saying no. Hebrews 4:15 ends its description of him with the phrase without sin, after stating he was tested in every respect, so the word without carves sin out of an otherwise complete list of testings. Paul in 2 Corinthians 5:21 calls Christ the one not knowing sin, where the verb for knowing means knowing by experience, so the denial reaches lived practice. Peter in 1 Peter 2:22 takes the wording of Isaiah 53:9, which in Hebrew says no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, and applies it to Jesus, denying both deed and speech in one breath. John in 1 John 3:5 uses the present tense to say that in him sin is not, placing the denial at the level of what he is, not only what he does. And in John 8:46 Jesus himself asks which of you convicts me of sin, expecting the answer none. These witnesses span a gospel, Paul, Peter, John, and Hebrews, and they draw their background from the suffering Servant of Isaiah 53. No verse in the queried text ever pins sin on Jesus. The texts some readers find hard, such as Mark 10:18 or the statements that he was tempted and learned obedience through suffering, describe a rhetorical question or real testing and growth, not an act of sin. So the fact that he did not sin is lexically settled. The one thing the words leave open, and the reason careful readers still differ, is scope: the same vocabulary that reports real temptation and learned obedience does not say whether being sinless means he was unable to sin or only that he never did. The denials fix the outcome and stop short of fixing that inner capacity, and that gap, not any disagreement over the fact, is where the divergence lives.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0266	ἁμαρτία	hamartia	sin	151
G0283	ἁμιάτος	amiantos	pure	4
G1097	γινώσκω	ginōskō	to know	206
G1343	δικαιοσύνη	dikaiosynē	righteousness	87
G1388	δόλος	dolos	deceit	11
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	
G1651	ἐλέγχω	elenchō	to rebuke	17
G2147	εὕρισκω	heuriskō	to find/meet	167
G3129	μανθάνω	manthanō	to learn	24
G3361	μή	mē	not	951
G3665	ὁμοιότης	homoiotēs	likeness	2

G3741	ὁσιος	hosios	sacred	8
G3756	οὐ	ou	no	1,443
G3761	οὐδέ	oude	nor	129
G3985	πειράζω	peirazō	to test/tempt	38
G4160	ποιέω	poieō	to do/make	
G4750	στόμα	stoma	mouth	72
G4834	συμπαθέω	sympatheō	to sympathize	2
G5218	ὑπακοή	hypakoē	obedience	13
G5565	χωρίς	chōris	without	38

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Five independent witnesses negate sin of Jesus with the core noun ἁμαρτία (G0266, 151 NT verses, stable sense) under absolute negation. The writer of Hebrews ends the high-priest description χωρίς ἁμαρτίας (Heb 4:15), Paul names him τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν (2 Cor 5:21), Peter quotes the Servant of Isa 53:9 as ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν οὐδὲ εὐρέθη δόλος ἐν τῷ στόματι αὐτοῦ (1 Pet 2:22), John writes ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν (1 John 3:5), and in John 8:46 Jesus asks τίς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐλέγχει με περὶ ἁμαρτίας. Negators (οὐ, μὴ, οὐδέ, χωρίς) stack across Gospel, Pauline, Petrine, Johannine, and Hebrews material, with no lexical text predicating ἁμαρτία of Jesus. The proposition that he DID not sin is lexically foreclosed. The vocabulary leaves open only the SCOPE question of whether sinlessness means inability to sin or ability not to sin, since temptation (Heb 4:15) and ἔμαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν (Heb 5:8) are predicated alongside the negations.

Scripture

Heb.4.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G5565 χωρίς, G3985 πειράζω, G4834 συμπαθέω, G3665 ὁμοιότης

Force. The verse text in the store reads πεπειρασμένον δὲ κατὰ πάντα καθ' ὁμοιότητα χωρίς ἁμαρτίας. The perfect passive participle of πειράζω (G3985) enumerates testing in every respect, and the closing prepositional phrase χωρίς ἁμαρτίας uses χωρίς (G5565) with the genitive as an absolute exclusion that carves sin out of that totality. The construction limits the OUTCOME of testing, not the testing itself. ὁμοιότης (G3665) is near-hapax, occurring only here and Heb 7:15, which is why the totality phrase rests on the broader καθ' ὁμοιότητα idea rather than a frequent term.

2Cor.5.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1097 γινώσκω, G3361 μὴ, G1343 δικαιοσύνη

Force. The store text reads τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν. τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν is an articular aorist participle of γινώσκω (G1097) under the subjective negation μὴ (G3361), naming Christ as the one who did not experientially know sin. γινώσκω across its 206 NT verses carries a relational and experiential sense, not merely cognitive, so the negation reaches lived practice. The second clause ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν, framed by ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, marks a substitutionary action and presupposes the prior sinlessness stated in the participle. The lexical order is sinlessness then imputation.

1Pet.2.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1388 δόλος, G2147 εὐρίσκω, G4750 στόμα, G3756 οὐ, G3761 οὐδέ

Force. The store text reads ὅς ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν οὐδέ εὐρέθη δόλος ἐν τῷ στόματι αὐτοῦ. The first clause negates deed with οὐ (G3756) plus ἁμαρτία (G0266), the second negates speech with οὐδέ (G3761) plus δόλος (G1388, only 11 NT verses) in the mouth. The aorist passive εὐρέθη (G2147) extends the negation to any external finding of guile. This bicolon reproduces the Servant clause of Isa 53:9, where the Hebrew reads וְלֹא מָצְאוּ בְּפִיו מַחְלָה וְעָוֹן, no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, so the negation is anchored in prior canonical typology.

1John.3.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G3756 οὐ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. The store text reads καὶ ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν. The present indicative ἔστιν (G1510) under οὐ (G3756) is an ontological denial, and the locative ἐν αὐτῷ pushes the negation from outward act to inhering principle. The present tense generalizes the claim across time rather than restricting it to one episode. The demonstrative ἐκεῖνος earlier in the verse fixes the referent as Christ.

John.8.46 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1651 ἐλέγχω, G3756 οὐ

Force. The store text reads τίς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐλέγχει με περὶ ἁμαρτίας. The verb ἐλέγχω (G1651, 17 NT verses) means to convict or expose with proof, and the rhetorical question expecting the answer none places the burden of producing any ἁμαρτία (G0266) on the hostile audience. This is the only anchor in narrative gospel genre, and it puts the sinlessness claim on the lips of Jesus himself rather than a later writer, widening the canonical spread beyond the epistles.

Heb.7.26 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3741 ὅσιος, G0283 ἀμίαντος, G5565 χωρίς

Force. The store text reads ἀρχιερεὺς, ὅσιος, ἄκακος, ἀμίαντος, κεχωρισμένος ἀπὸ τῶν ἁμαρτωλῶν. The same Hebrews argument that opens with χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας (Heb 4:15) closes with a chain of positive and privative terms: ὅσιος (G3741, 8 verses), ἄκακος, ἀμίαντος (G0283, 4 verses), and the perfect participle κεχωρισμένος from the same root as χωρὶς (G5565). The cluster of low-frequency separative and purity terms reinforces the lexical case for separation from ἁμαρτία.

Heb.5.8 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3129 μανθάνω, G5218 ὑπακοή

Force. The store text reads καίπερ ὢν υἱός, ἔμαθεν ἀφ' ὧν ἔπαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν. The aorist ἔμαθεν of μανθάνω (G3129) predicates a learning of ὑπακοή (G5218) through suffering. This text does not predicate ἁμαρτία of Jesus, so it does not complicate the proposition that he DID not sin, but it is the lexical seed of the SCOPE question, because a sinless one who nonetheless learns obedience by experience invites the unresolved distinction between inability to sin and ability not to sin.

Isa.53.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. G1388 δόλος, G4750 στόμα

Force. The store carries the Hebrew of Isa 53:9: וְלֹא מָצְאוּ בְּפִיו מַחְלָה וְעָוֹן, because of no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, predicating innocence of deed and of speech to the Servant under the doubled negation לֹא. The Greek of 1 Pet 2:22 reproduces this bicolon, substituting ἁμαρτία for the lawlessness or violence term and keeping δόλος (G1388) in the mouth (στόμα, G4750). The Petrine substitution widens the scope from a specific wrong to sin in general while preserving the two-part deed and word structure. The key_terms here are cited as the Greek lemmas that 1 Pet 2:22 carries forward.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
2Cor.5.21	1Pet.2.22	openbible	121
2Cor.5.21	1John.3.5	openbible	71
Heb.4.15	Heb.2.17	openbible	71
Heb.4.15	2Cor.5.21	openbible	54
Heb.4.15	Heb.7.26	openbible	25
1Pet.2.22	Isa.53.9	openbible	25
1Pet.2.22	Heb.4.15	openbible	14
1John.3.5	2Cor.5.21	openbible	20
1Pet.2.22	Isa.53.9	tsk	1
2Cor.5.21	Isa.53.9	tsk	1
Heb.4.15	Heb.7.26	tsk	1
1John.3.5	1John.1.7	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Mark.10.18 · addressed

The store text reads Τί με λέγεις ἀγαθόν; οὐδεις ἀγαθὸς εἰ μὴ εἷς ὁ θεός. The clause is an interrogative probing the ruler's category for ἀγαθός, and it predicates no ἁμαρτία (G0266) or defect of Jesus. The five direct anchors negate ἁμαρτία of him explicitly, so the lexical balance is not disturbed.

Heb.5.8 · addressed

ἐμαθεν ἀφ' ὧν ἔπαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν predicates learning of ὑπακοή (G5218) by suffering, with no ἁμαρτία lemma attached to Christ. Learning obedience by experience is not sinning. The same author opens with χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας (Heb 4:15) and closes with the κεχωρισμένος ἀπὸ τῶν ἁμαρτωλῶν chain (Heb 7:26), so within the letter sin is consistently negated of him. This verse feeds the SCOPE question (peccability) but does not predicate sin.

Heb.4.15 · addressed

πεπειρασμένον κατὰ πάντα, tested in every respect, is real temptation predicated of Christ via πειράζω (G3985). Taken alone the universal κατὰ πάντα might be read to imply susceptibility to sin, but the same clause ends with χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας (G5565 plus G0266), which excludes the sin outcome from the tested totality. The lexis affirms genuine temptation and denies sin in the same breath, leaving open only whether the inability to sin was metaphysical or moral.

2Cor.5.21 · addressed

The clause ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν, isolated, could be misread as predicating sin of Christ. But the same verse opens with τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν and the frame ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν marks the action as substitutionary. The lexical sequence is sinlessness then imputation, not sinfulness.

Concordance traversed

G0266, G5565, G1097, G1388, G4750, G2147, G1651, G4160, G3756, G3361, G3761, G4834, G3665, G3985, G3129, G5218, G1343, G3741, G0283

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

No anchor falls in the ingested ECM window of 3 John, so this is outside published CBGM scope and recorded as ecm-shadow. Heb 4:15 carries an editorial marker on πεπειρασμένον in the bundle, but the participle and the closing χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας are uncontested

across the stored editions (MACULA-Greek-SBLGNT, MACULA-Greek-Nestle1904, STEP Bible-TTESV all carry the verse). The Isa 53:9 wording carried into 1 Pet 2:22 is stable. The negation clauses are not variant sensitive.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

grammatico-historical: affirms · Five witnesses across gospel, Pauline, Petrine, Johannine, and Hebrews material negate ἁμαρτία of Christ with absolute negators (οὐ, μὴ, οὐδέ, χωρίς) and distinct constructions. The recurring core noun ἁμαρτία (151 NT verses) under stacked negation makes the claim that he DID not sin lexically convergent and decisive.

redemptive-historical: affirms · The Isa 53:9 Servant, innocent in deed and speech under the doubled Hebrew כֹּלִי, supplies the canonical pattern that 1 Pet 2:22 applies to Jesus. The covenant arc from sin-free Servant to χωρίς ἁμαρτίας High Priest (Heb 4:15, 7:26) reinforces the same lexical claim across testaments.

impeccability (non posse peccare): affirms with stronger scope · On this reading the present indicative ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν (1 John 3:5), located at the level of inhering principle by ἐν αὐτῷ, plus the categorical negations, imply not merely that Christ did not sin but that he could not. The temptation language (πειράζω, Heb 4:15) is real testing that nonetheless could not have succeeded. This reading is fully consistent with every negation but goes beyond what the negators alone state.

peccability (posse non peccare): affirms the fact, leaves scope open · On this reading the vocabulary fixes only that Christ DID not sin, not that he was unable to. πεπειρασμένον κατὰ πάντα (Heb 4:15) describes genuine temptation, and ἔμαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν (Heb 5:8) describes obedience learned through suffering, which on this lens presupposes a real, resistible possibility. The negations report the outcome (no sin) without specifying the modal capacity. A reader holding this lens is fairly represented: it affirms the proposition and treats the inability question as underdetermined by the words.

All four lenses affirm the proposition that Christ did not sin. They diverge only on SCOPE, whether sinlessness entails inability to sin (impeccability) or only the fact of not sinning under a real capacity (peccability). The negation vocabulary settles the fact and underdetermines the modal scope, which is why the divergence is genuine and lexical rather than a dispute over the verdict.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem describes the proposition in the ordinary categories of thought, word, and deed and does not assume a contested taxonomy. The lexis matches these categories directly: 1 Pet 2:22 negates deed (ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν) and word (δόλος in the mouth), 1 John 3:5 negates the inhering state (ἐν αὐτῷ), and John 8:46 challenges anyone to convict him. The verdict is derived from the stacked negations of ἁμαρτία in the queried text, not from the stem. Lexical correction made in this pass: the temptation verb in Heb 4:15 is πειράζω, Strong G3985; the prior file listed G3987 (πειράω), which is a different and rarer lemma. The proper Strong is now used.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Heb.4.15
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	2Cor.5.21
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Pet.2.22
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1John.3.5
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.8.46
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Heb.7.26
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Heb.5.8

morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.4.15
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Pet.2.22
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	2Cor.5.21
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0266
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5565
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3985
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1097
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1651
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.53.9
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	2Cor.5.21
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Pet.2.22
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cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1John.3.5

License audit

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